

Handout 8: Communication and Boundaries

Pat has told Alex multiple times that it really bothers them when they comment on their body weight. But again and again, Alex comments on Pat's figure, weight gains and losses, and their appearance in different kinds of clothes. Even when the comments seem flattering, they make Pat feel uncomfortable. Alex has just made yet another comment about Pat's size. What are the ways Pat can address this issue using the three different types of communication?

What's a passive way that Pat could respond to their boundaries being disrespected?

What's an assertive way Pat could respond to Alex's comments?

How might an aggressive response to Alex's crossing boundaries look?